How to Run ScamShield Pakistan in VS Code

Step-by-step guide for Windows

Step 1: Install what you need

- Install **Python 3.11 or later** from python.org. On the first installer screen, tick **"Add Python to PATH"**.
- Install **VS Code**, then add the **Python** extension from the Extensions tab (Ctrl+Shift+X).

Step 2: Open the project

- Extract the ZIP file first (don't run it from inside the ZIP).
- In VS Code, go to **File > Open Folder** and choose the `ScamShield_Pakistan` folder. You should see `app.py`, `scamshield/`, `tests/` and `requirements.txt` in the sidebar.

Step 3: Open the terminal

- Press **Ctrl+`** (or Terminal > New Terminal).

Step 4: Create and activate a virtual environment

```
python -m venv .venv
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

When it works, you'll see `(.venv)` at the start of the terminal line.

> **If PowerShell blocks the activation** with a "running scripts is disabled" error, run this once and then activate again:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned
```

Or switch the terminal to Command Prompt and use `.venv\Scripts\activate.bat` instead.

Step 5: Install the packages

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Step 6: Run the app

```
streamlit run app.py
```

Your browser should open at `http://localhost:8501`. If it doesn't, paste that address into the browser yourself. To stop the app, press **Ctrl+C** in the terminal.

Step 7: Run the tests (optional)

```
python -m unittest discover -s tests
```

Common Problems

`python` **is not recognized**	Python wasn't added to PATH. Reinstall it and tick the PATH option, or try `py -m venv .venv`.
`streamlit` **is not recognized**	The virtual environment isn't active, or the install failed. Check for `(.venv)` in the terminal and repeat Step 5.
VS Code uses the wrong Python	Press **Ctrl+Shift+P**, choose **Python: Select Interpreter**, and pick the one inside `.venv`.

> **Still stuck?** If you get an error, copy the full message and share it so it can be fixed.